

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

After years in hot seat, Carter exiting CTA

Retirement as president comes amid debate in Springfield about agency's future

By Sarah Freishtat, Alice Yin, Jake Sheridan and Gregory Royal Pratt
Chicago Tribune

Dorval Carter is out at the CTA. The transit agency president announced his retirement Monday in a CTA news release, after years in the hot seat as riders complained about unreliable service, conditions on trains and buses and concerns about personal safety.

He will step down at the end of this month, according to the release, before taking over as CEO of St. Anthony's Hospital.

Now Mayor Brandon Johnson,

who inherited Carter, faces one of the more important appointments for a Chicago mayor, as the CTA tries to pry a huge funding infusion out of state lawmakers for the cash-strapped agency.

Carter's retirement comes as a debate brews in Springfield about whether to combine the CTA with Metra, Pace and the Regional Transportation Authority, and how to fund local transit amid a looming \$771 million budget gap once federal COVID-19 relief funding runs out. Some lawmakers have pushed for addressing transit oversight and leadership before tackling the funding cliff, which could

hit as soon as next year.

Johnson, who has taken heat for defending Carter amid a long-running campaign for his resignation, lauded the outgoing transit chief in the release. "His leadership reimagined the movement of our city. His stewardship of the Red Line extension project is just one of the notable achievements in his historic career," Johnson wrote.

The blistering pressure Carter faced from city and state lawmakers included a majority of aldermen demanding his resignation last year, as well as Gov. JB Pritzker calling for an "evolution of the leadership" at the CTA as lawmakers first began to mull merging the region's four transit

Turn to Carter, Page 4



Chicago Transit Authority President Dorval Carter speaks Friday at a news conference announcing the final part of federal funding for the Red Line extension project. **ANTONIO PEREZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

MICHAEL MADIGAN TRIAL

'That's you laughing, sir, isn't it?'

Prosecutor launches into former speaker in cross-examination at packed courtroom

By Jason Meisner, Megan Crepeau and Ray Long
Chicago Tribune

Former House Speaker Michael Madigan contended last week that as a blue-collar leader with a strong work ethic, he was angry and upset when he found out close associates he'd recommended for jobs with utility giant Commonwealth Edison had actually done little or nothing for the money.

On Monday, however, the jury in Madigan's corruption trial heard a different side of the speaker, chuckling as he told his old friend Michael McClain that some of Madigan's political hires "have made out like bandits."

"That's you laughing, sir, isn't it?" Assistant U.S. Attorney Amarjeet Bhachu asked Madigan after playing the August 2018 wiretapped phone call, which Madigan's lawyers had fought hard to keep the jury from hearing.

Madigan confirmed that yes, it was.

The tape, which has the potential to be highly damaging to Madigan's case, was played near the outset of a tense cross-examination of Madigan,

Turn to Madigan, Page 2

Sentence reduced for woman who shot alleged abuser

In a case indicative of the justice system's slowly changing attitude toward domestic violence, a judge reduced the sentence of a Chicago woman who said she shot and killed her abuser in 2001.

Chicagoland, Page 3

Bally's resumes demolition for future casino

Work on the Bally's Chicago Casino complex resumed after the city approved a new plan for razing the last vestiges of the Freedom Center. **Business**

LA battles new fires

A growing force of firefighters battled massive infernos across the Los Angeles area. **Nation & World**



ANTONIO PEREZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Grant helping schools blaze new learning trails

Sixth grader Mariah Triggs, center, and classmates use play money to reinforce math exercises as they take part in a "hallway burst" where they present a project at Avalon Park Fine & Performing Arts School last week. Avalon Park is among four Chicago magnet schools that are sharing a \$15 million federal grant over five years to implement a model allowing students to create their own learning paths. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

CPS on 'financial brink,' Civic Federation report says



Chicago Public Schools CEO Pedro Martinez stands during a news conference regarding the financial future of CPS as well as an update on Chicago Teachers Union contract bargaining at CPS headquarters on Monday. **EILEEN T. MESLAR/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

State takeover shouldn't be out of the question, according to watchdog

By A.D. Quig and Nell Salzman
Chicago Tribune

The new Chicago Board of Education being seated Wednesday — the first to have elected members — will stare down a district on the financial brink: an imbalanced budget, rising costs, falling student headcount, a long list of infrastructure needs and steep debt and pension liabilities.

Budget watchdog group the Civic Federation warned current circumstances are "so serious that a state financial takeover ... is not and should not be out of the question," and urged the new board to right-size spending, make a long-term financial plan, and develop plans to advocate for revenue.

Asked about the report at a Monday afternoon news conference, union officials still fighting for a contract reiterated its opposition to cuts. "When the Civic Federation asks about what the

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TODAY'S WEATHER



High 17

Low 8

Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 14

\$4.00 city and suburbs and elsewhere
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